

Stakeholder Interview Transcript (Follow-Up / Deep-Dive)

Enterprise: Mentoring Division – Center for Student Affairs (CSA), University of Asia and the Pacific (UA&P)

Project: Enterprise Architecture Conceptual Solution (Academic Case Study)

Interviewee:

- Ms. Nina (Staff / Operations Coordinator, Mentoring Division, CSA)

Interviewers / Student Architects:

- Student 1 (Emmanuel Velasco – Lead Interviewer)
 - Student 2 (Deejay Clark Datu – Co-Interviewer)
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Verbatim Interview Transcript

[00:00] Ms. Nina: It's the CSA Office of Student Mentoring.

[00:03] Student 1: Okay.

[00:04] Ms. Nina: I'll... I'll do this, eh, para... (so that...) Ayan. (There.) Okay. So I think, yeah, best would be for you guys to know the Mentoring Program, so the definition of the Mentoring Program of the university, okay? So it's one of UA&P's hallmarks, and it... it's available to students, okay? It is used to supplement... used as a supplement to providing quality education and integral formation. Okay. Um... So the... uh, what do you call this, the goals of the Student Mentoring Program are the following:

One: to inform, orient, and guide the students throughout their university life and help them grow in their appreciation and assimilation of the university's educational principles and culture. I think it's recorded, so you can use that na lang. (instead.) Okay?

Next one is to contribute to the students' acquisition of desirable personal habits and professional competencies in preparation for professional life.

And lastly, to contribute to the integral formation of students by orienting them on their academic growth, assisting them in their professional direction, and helping them navigate through late

adolescence into young adulthood. Okay? So I think that would help you guys in the first part, in the, uh, what's this, in the introduction. Okay?

[02:24] Ms. Nina: So, there are two people working here in, uh, the Office of Student Mentoring. So, the first one is for the monitoring... assigned for the implementation of the whole program. Okay? Sec-... uh, sub-goals would be the monitoring, um, compiling, and submission of reports related to the policy, to the Mentoring Program policy. Okay? And then, uh, also included is the training and learning and development, uh, aspect for the mentors. Miss Kelai is currently working on just the external mentors coordination. Okay? So, that will address the... this one. Okay?

[03:16] Student 1: Sige po. (All right.)

[03:17] Ms. Nina: Yeah. All right. And then... wait. The IST Department is responsible for the creation of the specific tools, but they're not managing it right now. Okay. And then, for this, what you presented to us, the Google Sheets, the, what do you call this, the con-... the...

[03:42] Student 1: One for the... yes.

[03:44] Ms. Nina: Yeah, linking the two Google Sheets. IS-... IT Office, not IST, IT Office. IT Office... were... the people from the IT Office were able to do that already.

[03:57] Student 1: Ah, they linked it na? (already?)

[03:58] Ms. Nina: Yeah. So what they did is that whenever, uh, a mentor, uh, confirms the session log, it automatically updates in the, uh, database that we have. So, say for example, you, you were able to do two mentoring sessions by... uh, by the end of October, and your mentor was able to confirm it, we would, uh... it auto-... the, uh, database that we have for the all the students automatically updates. Okay? All right.

[04:34] Ms. Nina: The specific goals, the SMART... Okay, I'm... I'm going through your... your questions, okay? Para mabilis tayo. (So we can be quick.) All right. So the... this is yours, okay? 'Yung iba hindi ko na inano ha, kasi I think this is your solutions. O ayan, sa inyo na 'yan. Ayaw ko na... Basta kailangan ko no'ng first part, okay? (The others I didn't touch, okay, because I think this is your solutions. So there, that's yours. I don't want... As long as I need the first part, okay?)

The main goal for this year is to pair students with competent mentors, okay, and for all students to comply with the three sessions required per semesters... ay, per semester. Okay?

[05:20] Ms. Nina: All right. The number four question is, "Does the unit run any training or onboarding program for mentors? If so, what does it look like?" Yes. We do it in collaboration with HR. So it is part of the in-... uh, Development Program of the faculty and staff. It's sometimes, uh, is included in the IDP. Uh, what is the IDP, wait lang. (just a moment.) Para ma-... makuha niyo 'yung, uh, what's this, 'yung specific. (So that you can get the, uh, what's this, the specific.)

[06:17] Ms. Nina: Institutional Development Program, it's the IDP. That is what the faculty and staff undergo, uh, as part of their professional development. So the Mentoring, uh, Development Program, that's how we call it, Mentoring MDP, the Mentoring Development... ay, the Mentoring... the Mentor Development Program is part of the IDP. Okay? And then...

[06:54] Ms. Nina: Number five: eligibility criteria, okay? Um, there are several factors considered, okay? Um, familiarity of the per-... of the mentor with the program and the university; academic and professional experience. Uh, but we also have some in-... uh, uh, an internal crite-... scorecard that we use in evaluating proposed mentors.

[07:30] Student 1: 'Yung (The) internal scorecard is confidential?

[07:32] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[07:35] Ms. Nina: Okay. And then, "How are external mentors sourced?" Okay. Um, often through referrals and through their experience in the university. Okay? Some of the external mentors are... are either alumni of the university, or some have taught in the university and have, uh, are not... are no longer engaged in teaching. Um, there are others who are also, uh, part of, uh... a part of the university in one way or another. Say for example, they were part of activities within the university, um, or they were, uh, former employees. Okay?

[08:35] Ms. Nina: Uh, "Apart from the new policy, what are the strategies that we, uh, that we implement to encourage student participation in the Mentoring Program?" Prior to this, we used to have the Mentoring Month, okay; the Mentoring Space, okay. These are, uh, activities that, uh, that were implemented in the past: Meet Your Mentor, and also the pilot mentoring, uh, study. Okay?

[09:11] Student 2: Pero from the past na 'to? (But these are from the past already?)

[09:12] Ms. Nina: Yeah.

[09:13] Student 2: So they're not being implemented...

[09:15] Student 1: Being implemented...

[09:15] Student 2: ...implemented right now?

[09:16] Ms. Nina: Uh, they might be implemented by the second semester, but not all. Okay?

Because what we are focusing right now is the roll-out of the mentor-... uh, the new policy. Because as it is with the new policy, students should be able to engage in mentoring. Okay? I think you also need to highlight that in the mentoring policy, uh, what we have is that if you are not going to meet the three required sessions for two semesters, you will be on follow-up required status. Okay? So it means to say that CSA will get in touch with you, with the students, so that you will be able to

meet with the, uh, the required number of sessions. If that's not going to happen, that's not going to happen, it will affect your eligibility to enroll. Okay? Did I answer the questions pa? (yet?)

[10:41] Student 1: Yes po. (Yes, ma'am.)

[10:48] Ms. Nina: Baka mayro'n pa, eh, para... (Maybe there's more, so that...)

[10:54] Student 1: Uh, we still have other questions din, eh. (as well.)

[10:56] Ms. Nina: Sige, sure. (Go ahead, sure.)

[10:59] Student 1: But those were the important ones that we also wanted to ask.

[11:03] Ms. Nina: All right. So what else do you have for me?

[11:05] Student 1: Kasi, uh, actually, where Sir Pira told, or at least the entire class, where we all lacked in was trying to understand the "why" and purpose of the business. Most of us actually focused on how does the business operate, rather than at the core, 'yung ano 'yung mga (what are the) drivers. So 'yun, siguro (So that, maybe), what are the drivers of the Mentoring Unit?

[11:26] Ms. Nina: Uh, it's part of, uh... It's one of the main, uh, programs of the university for the holistic formation of the students. We are... You can also highlight that UA&P is one of the few universities that implement a mentoring program. Okay? Um, most universities only have guidance and counseling, they only have, uh, student services, but the mentoring program is unique. Okay? Um, to be honest, in the, uh, CHED Memorandum on, uh, Student Affairs, mentoring is not included in that. So it's a value-added, uh, quality, or value-added feature of the university for the students. That's why, uh, the policy is so designed that all students will be able to experience that feature or that quality.

[13:00] Student 1: So, ayun, yeah, integral formation, specifically holistic development, tama po? (correct?) Uh, what is the unit's definition of holistic development?

[13:11] Ms. Nina: Hmm, that would be the CSA's definition of holistic development, okay? Let me just capture it from... If you read the handbook, student mentoring program is also included in the handbook. This is the 2024–2025 version that I am looking at, but I think, uh, we are going to also, uh, release the sec-... the 2026–2027 upon, uh, upon, uh, approval, ManCom approval, okay? So holistic formation, yeah, involves your the personal, professional, and social life of the student. Okay? So, um, it aims for, uh, for the student to acquire and strengthen intellectual skills and, uh, mor-... moral criteria. Okay? Aims to help the students acquire and strengthen their intellectual skills and moral criteria. Okay? Let me just check if they... there is a published...

(Typing and browsing document from 13:40 to 19:00)

[19:01] Ms. Nina: Okay, so you can use this. This is the approved, uh, statement, okay? Para magamit niyo. (So you can use it.) Okay. "The CSA is the guardian of the student value chain.

UA&P's hallmark of values formation is promoted by CSA through the holistic formation of the student by the cultivation of university life outside the classroom as an effective complement to the academic course of study."

So through, uh, the Office of Student Mentoring, what we do is we, uh, we try to ensure that the students acquire and strengthen their, uh, intellectual skills and moral criteria. So that's more specific. Okay? So that, uh, there will be a holistic formation of the students' personal, professional, and social life. Okay? Those three things.

[20:35] Student 1: How does, um... What are the indicators that the student is holistically developed?

[20:43] Ms. Nina: That's very hard. That's a very hard question for, uh... because it's not just, uh, Student Mentoring that is part of the holistic formation, it's also, uh, the other units within CSA. So... what we aim to have is that, uh, the student would be able to be upstanding individuals when they leave the university.

[22:09] Student 1: I'm pretty sure Sir Pira will be... Sir Pira will ask, "What is the definition of upstanding?"

[22:16] Ms. Nina: Well, you should define that as your... as students yourselves.

[22:28] Ms. Nina: He asks a lot of questions, huh?

[22:30] Student 1: Yes. (Laughter) He... he actually is really... When we actually consulted with him on where we're at, he really grilled us with so many questions like, we said, "Holistic development is the goal of the Mentoring Unit." And sabi niya (he said), "So what does holistic development mean?" Then we say that it's for the student is an upstanding student. Then he said, "So what does that mean, upstanding student?" It's like, there's so many questions after each definition. It's like looking at the root talaga. (really.)

[23:01] Student 2: And it's quite confusing lang din kasi I think ang hinahanap niya is something specific, concrete, parang measurable, gano'n. (just as well because I think what he is looking for is something specific, concrete, like measurable, like that.) Kaya nahihirapan kaming mag-ano. (That's why we're having a hard time to do it.)

[23:15] Ms. Nina: Okay. Because right now, what we're focusing on is the mentoring pol-... the implementation of the mentoring policy. We're not really, uh... Kasi (Because) the other side of things, uh, what do you call... the other side of things, we're not really that focused on that, uh, because the... if we implement the mentoring policy, that means that there is, uh, the... there is engagement between the mentors and the mentees. The... the next, uh, step for us is to improve on

the quality of the mentoring relationship. But right now, what we're focused on is the basics, you know, for it... for us to make sure that it's happening. We need to (laughter) implement this!

[24:18] Student 1: How Sir Pira, uh, parang (like) explained that, in order to improve something, we have to first understand 'yung 'yung 'yun nga, 'yung (the, that's it, the) existence, the "why" of the business, 'yung mga (the) strategies. Then from there, we can implement a solution. So for the for our implementation of the policy, we might be able to help you in some way if we try to understand muna 'yung (first the) what the Mentoring Unit is all about.

[24:49] Ms. Nina: The thing is, I think he's more... his line of questioning is focused on businesses, but it's not exactly a business. Yes, it's operations, eh, sa amin. (in our case.) So it's a service, it's not... Kasi (Because) you can argue that the... a service is a business in itself, but if he's focused on the business itself, it's the university! (Laughter) It's the education business that he's... is going to talk about. Okay.

[25:38] Student 1: On on that end siguro (maybe), the unit... is the unit really obligated or mandated to facilitate the Mentoring Program?

[25:50] Ms. Nina: Yes. Yeah. We are required to implement it. We are just the implementors.

[25:57] Student 1: So, what will happen if the unit does not exist or is, let's say, hopefully not, na-shut down? (shut down?)

[26:08] Ms. Nina: Hmm. Then the schools would have to take on the mentoring program, if that's the case. Kasi dalawa lang 'yan, eh. (Because there's only two possibilities.) If the unit will be shut down, it means to say the school will no longer, uh, offer the mentoring program, or if it's offered, and then it will go back to schools having... the different colleges having their own, uh, approach in implementing the program. So the unit exists so that the, uh, implementation of the program is, as much as possible, uniform across all schools.

[26:50] Student 2: Nagiging parang centralized na sa isang unit na lang. (It becomes like centralized to just one unit.)

[26:57] Ms. Nina: That's the term: centralized. Because for the schools, uh, what they can do is to pair the students, but the development of the, uh, the training and development of the mentors, and institutional services to the students with regards to mentoring, they cannot... uh, it's up to the Office of Student Mentoring. Yeah.

[27:35] Ms. Nina: Basically, 'yun talaga 'yun, eh. (that's really it.) What would be... what would happen if we're not able to...

[27:42] Student 1: If the pol... policy, 'yung program (the program), if the program is mandatory or is, 'yun (that), mandatory to be facilitated, um, even without the context of the new policy, are students required to participate in it?

[28:00] Ms. Nina: Prior to the implementation of the new policy, it was voluntary. So students are paired with mentors, but, uh, meeting their mentors is up to them. So it's, uh, up to the student or to the mentor if they're they will be able to meet within the semester. But it's the first ye... uh, this is the first year of the implementation wherein you are required to have three sessions per semester.

[28:36] Student 1: So, my next question would be: what changed it to become mandatory?

[28:42] Ms. Nina: The university president is very, uh, interested, he is very invested in the mentoring program. And he wants all students to have, uh, an engagement and to see the value in the program.

[29:08] Student 1: To see the value... So if if the program did not succeed, does that mean parang (like) the program would be tempo... temporary or shut down?

[29:19] Ms. Nina: No! No, no, no. Uh, what he wants to see... Okay, I think you're coming from it in a different angle. Uh, what I... what I meant by, uh, see... by the students seeing the value in the program is them experiencing the program, undergoing the program, okay, and see the value that mentoring can give them.

[29:51] Student 1: On value, uh, how does the unit define value, or what is that value that's being given to students?

[30:02] Ms. Nina: Ah, that they are, uh, given guidance in their personal, professional, and social life. Because, uh, the mentoring program comes in before any, uh, before the student... Okay, ideally, the mentoring program comes in before the student has any detrimental problem. Say for example, if the student wants to get in touch, uh, to know more about, uh, the processes within the university, or say for example, the student is having, uh, a personal decision to ma... is, uh, what do you call this, the the student is exploring professional, uh, professional paths, okay? So the mentor can help him or her, okay? During mentoring, the... it is also one thing that we want, uh, students to experience that the mentor challenges the mentee to offer a new perspective in thinking and in approaching things.

[31:56] Student 1: So, uh, next question: where do you envision the Mentoring Unit being in the next one to three years?

[32:06] Ms. Nina: Within CSA, still, because it's under the holistic formation. Um, second would be: it will be a strong program that all students enjoy, not just because it's required! (Laughter) You know? You enjoy! You actually want to have mentoring, and you see the value in it, you know?

[32:33] Student 1: I do enjoy it naman din. (as well.)

[32:35] Ms. Nina: Good for you! It's also, it's, uh... it's nice to hear that. I hope everyone shares that sentiment, but you know... (Laughter)

[33:00] Student 1: Okay. So who actually sets the strategic direction for the Mentoring Program?

[33:05] Ms. Nina: Ah, it's a combination of this... it's a discussion between the unit, the the CSA Operations Committee, and the Management. Okay? We also collaborate with the different schools. Okay? Because say for example, uh, SSE has this particular thrust in making sure that mentoring is, uh, geared towards, uh... it's more focused on the professional—this is just an example, ha—more focused on the professional growth of their students, the others are more focused on, say, academics, or, uh, sometimes there are also schools that take the mentoring program as a complementary, uh, program for mental health concerns of the students to, you know, help them, uh, to be able to give students the help they need before they reach a mental health concern or before they have a mental health concern. So that's why we collaborate with schools.

[34:21] Student 1: What specific questions does the university leadership ask regarding mentoring?

[34:30] Ms. Nina: I am not the best person to answer that, because it's Miss Concha, the Executive Director, who converses with the ManCom about... about mentoring.

[34:47] Student 1: Or, in that case, what do you think they would be most likely asking?

[34:53] Ms. Nina: We check the frequency of the mentoring sessions. Uh, we also check the, uh, quality of, uh... the evaluation of the students and the mentors, uh, the evaluation of their perspective on mentoring coming from the students and the mentors. So we also report on that.

[35:23] Student 1: Before the implementation of the policy, how was that, uh, quality and evaluation recorded or tracked?

[35:32] Ms. Nina: Um, prior to this, uh, they... we used to have the mentoring portal, okay? But it got shut down. Uh, it's no longer being used, and then they shifted to using a Google Form to record the the occurrences, the occurrence of, uh, of the mentoring sessions. Um, and then for the evaluation, I think they were able to share, uh, the evaluation form through Google Forms to both mentors and mentees.

[36:33] Student 1: Do you have any specific, uh, like red flag red flag triggers that, um, require the intervention from the leadership?

[36:44] Ms. Nina: Low mentoring rec-... uh, logs. Low mentoring.

[36:51] Student 1: Does that happen frequently, or rarely?

[36:55] Ms. Nina: Because mentoring was voluntary before, so we were not able to capture the frequency of the mentoring sessions as faithfully as we would want to. Um, before, during, uh, after the, well... the me-... during the impleme-... uh, the implementation of the mentoring portal, when it was still live, it was the mentors who logged the sessions. And not all mentors logged the sessions! (Laughter) So now, the responsibility is with the students, and the students being students, if it's a requirement, you comply.

[37:41] Student 1: Yes.

[37:44] Ms. Nina: You see the shift, and... (Laughter) So if you want to capture the essence of mentoring, the frequency...

[37:55] Student 1: Has to be from the students.

[37:57] Ms. Nina: Yes. And you also us-... you also have to look at it from the perspective of the mentors: they handle several students at once, whereas the mentoring session will be individual to the student. The mentor might, you know, think that I'm doing mentoring with you, but I was actually talking to him. There there's a there's a human aspect in that sense, eh. But for the student, if you record it, it's individual to you, it's personal to you.

[38:45] Ms. Nina: And there are, I think, mentors who do group mentoring as well. There are some. Say for example, you share the same mentor and then you're friends, you're okay with mentoring, or talking as a group, so that happens as well.

[39:06] Student 2: But do do mentors, ay, do students still do that today, group mentorship, or individual na lang? (only?)

[39:13] Ms. Nina: I don't have the data yet.

[39:25] Student 1: Why does the non-participation of students actually matter to the university?

[39:32] Ms. Nina: Because mentoring is supposed to be one of the hallmarks of the university, and if you don't have the data to support that it's actually happening, how can we claim that it's one of the best features of the university?

[39:54] Student 1: So it's more of evidence talaga. (really.)

[39:57] Ms. Nina: Yes! I was about to say evidence, in the same manner, say for example, you choose somebody as a valedictorian or a, uh, say, uh, he or she has Latin honors, that person has

the, uh, transcript to back her him or her up. You can't just claim something just because you think it's happening without numbers to back you up, right? Or evidence.

[40:31] Student 1: So let's say that the participation is at 100%, what would... Let's say, let's say...

[40:39] Ms. Nina: I hope! (Laughter) I wish!

[40:41] Student 1: So what would change within the university if that was the case?

[40:48] Ms. Nina: Um, if the participation is 100%, what would change? I hope, in that sense, uh, the university will be more... that's how... I'm trying to be very careful in what I will say! (Laughter)
Because:

One: well, we can back up the claim that it is a hallmark of the university. That's one.

Two, uh, we can, um, hold, because they used to hold, uh, what's this, international mentoring conference here in the university, hosted by the university. Maybe if we're able to do that, we can... if we're able to meet that particular, uh, target, we will be able to have, uh, a similar program or activity, okay, wherein we can showcase the mentoring program of the university to other audience, to international and local audience.

What else? If we hit the target of 100%... I guess it will also set the university apart from the other universities, you know? That all students... that we can rightfully say that all students have good mentoring relationships with their mentors.

[43:20] Student 1: Um, okay. So what organizational capabilities does the unit currently lack that prevent it from achieving its goals?

[43:31] Ms. Nina: We experience a lot of birth pain, growing pains this semester. We're just two-way... two months in this semester, so we're implementing the policy while ensuring that our database is, uh, what is a sound one, (laughter) and, uh, the processes that we have right now, we're linking them together, you know? Um... ayan. (there.) And also, well, I can... this is not, uh, an answer to your question, but it's somewhat related: what I noticed the past few weeks that actually is a biggest... is the biggest problem for us is that, even if the student has been paired with a mentor, there are requests wherein they ask to be paired with another mentor, and that opens up another process that we need to, um, put in. Okay? So that might be something that can help you, if you can come up with a solution that will, uh, that will streamline that process.

Because the thing is, when we have requests, say for example, you're paired with Dr. Ladao, you request to be paired, say, with Dr. Joven, okay? But, uh, for us to do that, when we receive your request, we have to check with Dr. Ladao, Dr. Joven, and the school. If all three are okay, that's when we... and we're... and OSM, so that mentoring is okay with the with the with the change, that's when it will happen. But we would have to ask, say for example, uh, the school to update

their records, we would have also have to update our records, and update those two mentors about the change.

[46:01] Student 1: I think, uh, you explained that process before, so if I remember corr-... uh, please correct me if I'm wrong, um, that you should... you first email or get in touch with the current mentor regarding the the the request for change, then the the new mentor, then followed by the school, and final approval by ManCom?

[46:23] Ms. Nina: Ah no, not ManCom.

[46:24] Student 1: Not ManCom?

[46:25] Ms. Nina: Not ManCom. OSM lang. (Just OSM.)

[46:27] Student 1: Ay, sorry, oo nga pala, hindi pala ManCom, dito sa inyo sa... (Oh, sorry, yes that's right, not ManCom, here on your end in...)

[46:31] Ms. Nina: Yeah. Now, uh, I think you were th-... thinking about the, uh, approved list of mentors.

[46:36] Student 1: Ay, yes, that one.

[46:38] Ms. Nina: Yeah. So I'm trying to find a way to automate that process, because it's going to be something that's going... If we automate it, that we just get the final approval or something, it's going to be easy for us. But right now, the system is that way, it's manual. But if you get like a hundred requests! (Laughter) And of course, it's very important to the student who's requesting for the change in mentor.

[47:15] Student 1: Is this, uh, is this like a spike in requests?

[47:19] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[47:21] Student 1: Oh, I'm sure for them, for, I think from, I think the reason why they decided to change now is because the of the policy, parang (like) they were satisfied with their old mentors no'ng (when) and then they didn't meet with them. And then I think you mentioned before, 'no, that the reason why a student would have their mentor changed without, uh, them requesting it specifically is because they did not establish a relationship.

[47:45] Ms. Nina: Mhm.

[47:46] Student 1: Parang (Like), because of that, the sudden implementation is forcing or wanting, is making students want to go back to who they were comfortable with at the start.

[47:55] Ms. Nina: Yes, that's one. Two, um, not everyone were, uh, was able to meet with their mentors before, eh. So sometimes the pairings are, the pairings caught them, uh, catch them off-guard, na (that), "I don't know this person, and then I'm paired with this person." So, ayon. (there.)

[48:19] Student 2: Um, regarding 'yung (the) mentor pairing, uh, if I remember correctly, you mentioned before na (that) you guys have to evaluate kung (if) valid ba 'yung (the) request?

[48:32] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[48:33] Student 2: May Is there a Is there a criteria for that ba, like a checklist, or kayo mismong nag-i-evaluate ano, one by one? (Is there a criteria for that, like a checklist, or you yourselves evaluate, what, one by one?)

[48:43] Ms. Nina: It depends on the school kasi. (because.) Some schools would want their students to be paired with mentors coming from their own school, okay? So, uh, it really depends on the thrust of the school. Um, for the evaluation of the pairing, uh, in the change of pairing, it depends on the availability of the mentor, the capacity as well. Okay? Say for example, uh, I'll I'll use Doc James as... (Laughter)

[49:21] Student 1: Okay lang po. (It's okay.)

[49:22] Ms. Nina: There are a lot of students who want Doc James to be his men-... to be his mentor. Say for example. But his capacity is only up to 25, because he has other engagements within the university. He's the Vice Dean, he's part of Faros, he's teaching statistics, so, you know, it... if one student would want to have him again as his mentor, because he was his mentor previously and now he's paired with another, it might be a little difficult to pair him with Sir James.

[50:08] Student 1: Uh, on the capabilities of the unit, um, other capabilities, how does the unit manage or manage to balance between the institutional policy and the operational independence of individual schools?

[50:26] Ms. Nina: In managing that... Well, since we're implementors, the tendency is that we just collaborate with them, so we are independent in that sense from the schools, but we are not independent from ManCom! (Laughter) Okay? I don't think that any school or any unit within the university is independent of ManCom. Okay? Um, how do we manage it? Um, we have internal processes that, uh, do not require the approval of the schools. Okay? The nature of our relationship with the schools is collaborative in nature, uh, collaborative. Okay? It's just that, um, I think like with every other relationship, it's a strike of balance between respecting their preferences and making sure that your own set of processes are implemented well. Okay?

[51:56] Student 1: And, uh, what would these types of internal processes be, or some examples of these?

[52:04] Ms. Nina: Okay. Like, sometimes we make executive, not executive, internal decisions as to who to how as to who, how to pair a certain student. Okay? Um, sometimes we also make internal decisions as to, uh... well, the implementation of the recording of the sessions was, uh, an

independent decision, so we just presented it to the schools: "This is what will happen. It's the students who will be doing this. What you just need to do is to confirm or request for a correction. That's what the mentors will do." So, it was collaborative because they are still part of the of the process, but the decision came from the unit. Okay? Um, what else, uh, independent? Uh, the kind of development programs that we give the mentors, okay, it's independent of the schools. There was also, uh, a program, a soft skills program roll-out the year before last, I think that was 2024–2025, that the Mentoring, uh, Unit, uh, implemented, and it was independent of the schools, so, yeah. Collaborative lang, but independent. (Collaborative only, but independent.)

[53:46] Student 1: How does the unit approve mentors?

[53:51] Ms. Nina: Scorecard! I mentioned earlier!

[54:02] Ms. Nina: And various factors, say for example, the level of engagement, level of familiarity, and experience. I think I mentioned that kanina, 'di ba? (earlier, right?) Familiarity with the program, university, spirit, academic and professional experience, and the scorecard.

[54:22] Student 1: And this the the exact, uh, criterias are confidential too?

[54:27] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[54:37] Student 1: On a summary, how does the Mentoring Unit filter out, uh, what's a better word... I don't want to use the word "bad"... I don't want to use the word "bad".

[54:52] Ms. Nina: We get, uh, information from different sources, okay? Okay? So, no, let it out. We get information about, uh, the program, the mentors, and the mentees from different stakeholders. That's a better term, stakeholders, so it's not just you, it's not just, you know, it's not just the students, the stakeholders. So who are the stakeholders? Ayan na naman, 'di ba? (There you go again, right?) Okay. So, the stakeholders mainly are the students, you're the stakeholders; uh, the University Management Committee; uh, the different Operations Committee, 'di ba? (right?) And, I think, the men-... the faculty din. (too.) Faculty and staff. Okay? In mentoring, I can, what I can say... what I can say is that there are always many moving parts. You can use that term! There are many moving parts. In pairing one student, there are many moving parts, and because they are constantly moving, (laughter) it's rather hard to stay static. It's a dynamic process actually, if you may. Because right now, while we're talking, I got like three requests for change of mentor! So, you know, it's something that... Ayan. (There.)

[56:48] Student 1: With regards... what's a better word other than I don't want to use the word "bad", eh. Let's say...

[56:58] Ms. Nina: Not a good fit? Oo. (Yes.)

[57:00] Student 1: 'Yun, 'yun, (That, that,) not a good fit. Um, were there instances of mentors in the list that were not a good fit?

[57:10] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[57:12] Student 1: So, what did the unit do?

[57:15] Ms. Nina: We did not engage them the following school year. Because if, uh... if the stake-... if we get information from the stakeholders that this is not a good fit and you want a holistic formation, uh, for the students, so, you know, why push for it if it's not going to achieve the goal? If it's going to be detrimental to the student?

[57:59] Student 1: Does the unit currently employ any strategies to prevent students from wanting to change their mentors?

[58:08] Ms. Nina: We try to match them as best as we can! That's the best thing that we can... That's the best, uh, strategy that we have right now. But we're hoping... Ah, going back to your question, one to two years, what do we hope to do is that we hope that we can have an automated and foolproof way of matching students with mentors.

[58:35] Student 1: Well, that one is handled specifically by the schools, 'di ba? (right?)

[58:38] Ms. Nina: Yes, so we hope that we will be able to come up with, you know, how to do that. That, say for example, um, we would be able to get information coming from the mentee, that this is their, uh, this is his or her goals for mentor-... uh, for mentoring for this school year, and this is the kind of mentor that he or she would want, we'll be able to match it with the roster that we have. That's a very lofty goal. (Laughter) Because if we are able to do that, we would lessen the requests for change in mentors.

[59:31] Student 2: Yeah.

[59:32] Ms. Nina: 'Di ba? (Right?) If there's, say for example, from you, Emman, I think you're a good fit with Doc James.

[59:39] Student 1: Yes.

[59:40] Ms. Nina: If we're able to do that for all the thousands stud-... because we have 1,800 students to pair! So, of course, it won't happen. It's just a lofty...

[59:50] Student 1: Lofty goal.

[59:51] Ms. Nina: Yeah.

[59:54] Student 1: Sana, there I think maybe there is a process that can actually automate it, but at the moment, we still have to find out how.

[60:03] Ms. Nina: Yes.

[60:07] Student 1: So, we're on risks. What external dependencies does the or that pose currently a great risk to the unit when it comes to the mentoring cycle?

[60:25] Ms. Nina: For the pairings, it's because we're dependent on schools, so that's one. Uh, it's a risk kasi, uh... Well, I think I mentioned this before, and I you mentioned it, that the enrollment list is dependent on the Registrar's Office, and some, and this year, they extended, so we don't have, we didn't get the final list as early as we wanted it, as early as we wanted. That's one, that's their that's first risk. Second would be the pairings, it's dependent on schools, so it depends on the people, uh, from the schools tasked to do the pairings, depends on their availability. The third one would be, um, even if we have this, uh, the process of logging the sessions in place, we're not entirely sure if the students will be able to follow that, or to, you know, to use it to its to the level of capacity or engagement that we want.

[61:45] Student 1: Are there any, uh, processes to sort, resolve these issues?

[61:53] Ms. Nina: Right now, what I'm holding on to is the policy, because it's a, (laughter) it's a requirement for the students. Uh, another risk, um, availability of the mentors. Even if the student, uh, requests for sessions, if the mentor is unavailable, the mentoring session won't happen.

[62:17] Student 1: True.

[62:18] Ms. Nina: 'Di ba? (Right?)

[62:19] Student 1: So mostly just the policy lang, just to hope for the students to actually log their sessions?

[62:26] Ms. Nina: Right now, yes.

[62:28] Student 1: And what about for the dependency on the schools and enrollment? Anything that's being implemented towards like speed up the process?

[62:39] Ms. Nina: Um, okay. I guess we would have to start earlier, uh, the next school year, this coming cycle. Okay? So, um, because it's the the policy was released August 4. So after it was released, that's only when we were able to identify the roll-out and how we'll go about it. Now, uh, in the coming semester, since we're able to identify the, uh, the pain points in the roll-out, we'll be, I hope that we'll be able to have a better a better experience. Okay?

Um, another concern that we have is, well, I I kept on mentioning about this, the capacity of the mentors, right? So, we're trying to come up with a system wherein we'll be able to identify their capacity before the, uh, before the end of the semester, so that by next semester, we'll be able to, uh, pair them with the, uh, we pair them with mentees at the level of engagement that they have expressed.

[64:21] Student 1: What, okay, what about constraints that are non-negotiable in changing any of the processes within mentoring?

[64:31] Ms. Nina: The three sessions is non-negotiable, 'di ba? (right?) So, (laughter) the three sessions per semester. Because we're also checking if we'll be able to monitor, 'di ba? (right?) So that's non-negotiable. And then, there are a lot of things that we'll we would have to see by the end of this this semester. Not the school year, the end of the semester.

[65:19] Student 1: Uh, siguro (maybe) last two questions, or hopefully last two: if the unit could redesign the pairing and monitoring from scratch with none of today's, let's say, constraints, such as the the sheets and the Google Forms, what would that look like?

[65:35] Ms. Nina: It will be centralized. So, like what I said, it will be dependent on the, uh, the kind of the input coming from the students and also the mentors. So matching of the data that we get from the mentees and the mentors.

[66:13] Student 1: And are there any other programs or purposes that we haven't asked about?

[66:23] Ms. Nina: We talked about the... I think we talked about the communication of the... We talked about the change of mentors. Um, you haven't asked how we select the mentors who will undergo the, uh, development program. Because one development program might be, uh, what's this, might be a good fit for this mentor, another might be, uh, might be, uh, for another kind of mentor.

[67:10] Student 1: Oh, so this one, it's not like the mentors choose which program to go under?

[67:15] Ms. Nina: No, it's the unit that, uh, that invites them. Say for example, this person is, this mentor is a new mentor, and he or she is, uh, has not undergone the initial part of the, uh, development program for mentors. So the the session that he or she will attend will be on the basics of mentoring, how to go about how to approach mentoring from the perspective of the university, uh, and then if this another person is a seasoned mentor, so the development program will be different.

[68:01] Student 1: Siguro (Maybe), how many of these mentoring development programs are there?

[68:06] Ms. Nina: We usu-... the idea would be around four to five per year. They're able to do that last school year without the implementation of the policy, kasi. (because.) So right now, the resources are, uh, focused on the implementation.

[68:37] Student 1: How, but does each one of these programs differ?

[68:41] Ms. Nina: Mhm. It depends on the topic and the goal of the session.

[69:08] Student 1: You have any, Clark?

[69:09] Student 2: Wala na. (None.)

[69:10] Student 1: Wala na? (None anymore?) Let me review. Uh, just let me review my notes, I think I have one more.

(Reviewing notes from 69:15 to 69:34)

[69:34] Student 1: Ah, okay. Siguro (Maybe), what would be like the expected outcome when the mentors undergo these mentoring development programs?

[69:47] Ms. Nina: It will improve the mentoring, uh, relationship between the mentor and the mentee.

[69:55] Student 1: Then what would be an indicator of that, that good relationship?

[70:00] Ms. Nina: Positive evaluation from both mentor and mentee.

[70:48] Student 1: I think that's all the questions I have. Uh, do you have...?

[70:52] Student 2: Right now, none.

[70:53] Student 1: I think that concludes, uh, what we want.

[70:58] Ms. Nina: All right! (Laughter)

[70:59] Student 1: Uh, hopefully, Sir Pira, or whatever we produce will be up to Sir Pira's standards.

[71:05] Ms. Nina: Okay. I hope so as well.

[71:08] Student 1: I mean, uh, to be fair, no, not fair, I mean, Sir said naman (anyway) that the project is going to is really going to involve a lot of iterations talaga. (really.) At least it's not graded, eh. Currently, it's just, uh, just submit submit lang, but it doesn't (just submit, but it doesn't) hold any weight in our grades. Parang (Like) I think it's the the final product lang talaga (only really) that's has the, uh, full weight.

[71:31] Ms. Nina: Okay. So what do you what do you hope to achieve after this? Like after you submit that, what's what's going to happen?

[71:39] Student 1: Another session for the revision. I'm pretty sure Sir is going to say that we're going to revise it again. Parang he wants it like keep revising it until we get it right. So, I'm we're expecting, siguro, uh, maybe one to two more revisions in the future, and after that, siguro, next phase na. (maybe, next phase already.) Sir hasn't explained what the next phases are yet, in detail. And then, yeah, uh, after those revisions and then the next phase, then the or whatever phases are next will be leading up to the final submission, which is, uh, it's called, uh, an Enterprise Architecture Proposal document, which outlines the, uh, proposed solution to improving the unit.

[72:31] Ms. Nina: I hope you come up with something. I'm... this might be something that, ano, you can explore. I'm, uh, thinking kasi, say for example, uh, with job matching, that's something that we

can do for mentor-mentee matching, pairings. So explore how, say for example, Job... Jobs... ano ba 'yun? JobStreet, or Kalibrr matches the, uh, the users with available positions or roles.

[73:24] Student 1: I think, uh, that wraps up for today's meeting.

[73:28] Ms. Nina: Thank you! Sorry, tuloy, na-late ako. (Sorry that I was late.)

[73:31] Student 1: Thank you.